ILLIA SHPAK

Engineering Leader | Platform, Reliability & Security

London / Dubai | Working globally
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Engineering leader with 15+ years building platforms, security foundations, and delivery capabilities across fintech, banking, fashion, and travel. Combines hands-on architecture with distributed team leadership, executive collaboration, and multi-million dollar cloud contract negotiation. Focused on making growth reliable, secure, and economically sustainable.

SELECTED BUSINESS IMPACT

50% lower infrastructure spend at Lean through FinOps governance and cloud optimization.
$500K saved at DREST while moving deployments from weekly to multiple times per hour.
Seed through Series B at Lean: infrastructure supporting a platform serving 250+ clients and processing $2B+ in transactions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of DevOps & SRE

Lean Technologies | London / Dubai / Riyadh | 2022-Present

- Led platform infrastructure for a regulated MENA fintech from seed stage through a $33M Series A (Sequoia) and a $67.5M Series B (General Catalyst).
- Implemented FinOps governance, infrastructure optimization, and cloud contract negotiation, reducing infrastructure spend by 50%.
- Led infrastructure and security work supporting SAMA fintech licensing in Saudi Arabia, with CIS-hardened Kubernetes and cloud infrastructure.
- Designed and executed business continuity and disaster recovery across OCI, GCP, and AWS, with RPO=0 and RTO at or below 2 hours.
- Built golden paths and developer self-service platforms; achieved DORA Elite metrics and applied AI-assisted workflows to engineering operations.
- Built a distributed DevOps & SRE function across four regions, growing from 2 to 8 engineers while supporting a platform serving 250+ clients, including Binance and Tabby.

Environment: GCP, OCI, AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Argo CD, Vault, FinOps, SAMA, CIS, BCP/DR

VP Cloud / Systems Architect

JPMorgan Chase | London | 2021-2022

- Contributed to the architecture of a global digital call center platform, with real-time data integration microservices and intelligent call routing.
- Built WebRTC quality-metrics pipelines. The solution was presented at AWS re:Invent 2022 as reference architecture.

Environment: AWS, Python, Kafka, Kinesis, Spinnaker, Terraform

Head of DevOps & Security

DREST | London | 2019-2021

- Reported to the CEO/CTO and led infrastructure and security work for the business.
- Identified inefficiencies and led a full-stack migration and re-architecture, saving $500K.
- Transformed deployments from weekly to multiple times per hour and implemented the AWS Well-Architected Framework.

Environment: AWS, EKS, CircleCI, Neptune, GraphQL, GDPR

Lead DevOps Engineer

Burberry, via EPAM | London | 2017-2019

- Reduced infrastructure costs by 40% and managed GitLab supporting 150+ engineers.
- Led AWS security hardening and completed remediation in 3 weeks against a 2-month plan.
- Worked across enterprise-scale ELK, Akamai CDN, and Kubernetes orchestration.

Environment: AWS, Kubernetes, Chef, ELK, Akamai

Senior DevOps / SRE Engineer

Thomas Cook, via EPAM | Minsk / London | 2011-2017

- Led a team of 12 engineers and migrated EU data centers covering 400+ instances with minimal downtime.
- Deployed monitoring for 500+ instances and delivered performance testing, database optimization, and automation at enterprise scale.

Environment: Linux, Puppet, Chef, Oracle, MySQL, Zabbix

LEADERSHIP & TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

Leadership: distributed team building, 200+ technical interviews, OKRs/KPIs, executive collaboration, vendor negotiation, and engineering culture.
Platform & reliability: multi-cloud architecture, GKE/EKS/OKE, GitOps, developer self-service, SLO/SLI frameworks, incident response, and validated failover runbooks.
Security: zero-trust networks, privileged access management, SOC/SIEM capability, CIS Level 1 hardening, and work across SAMA, CBUAE, ISO 27001, GDPR, and NIST.
Operations: FinOps, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, ELK, AI-assisted observability, LLM toolchains, and infrastructure automation.

PRODUCTS BUILT

DzeTruck: B2B construction logistics marketplace connecting contractors with transport providers. Acquired paying B2B clients. Firebase, React, Flutter, and automated App Store / Google Play releases.
Menu Scanner: AI-powered dietary analysis using computer vision and NLP. Next.js, GCP Cloud Run, Google Cloud Vision, and Vercel edge delivery.

CREDENTIALS & CONTINUED LEARNING

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate | GCP Professional Cloud Architect | Chef Certified Developer
Additional training: Google Project Management; Y Combinator Startup School; SRE: Measuring & Managing Reliability; ELK Machine Learning.